

# Imaging

## 2.1 Touching up images

Images clicked with cameras can have minor yet disappointing faults that need to be corrected. At times, the image may be too bright, or too dark, or a particular colour which appeared bright may be too dull. Picasa 3 is a free tool from Google that can be used to fix up an image.

Once Picasa 3 starts up and is installed, it will automatically detect all the images on the computer. This can be changed during the installation, to make Picasa pick up only images that are in the My Documents folder. There is no option to disallow any kind of automatic detection, which is to make the software easy, but is also irritating. You can manually add images by going to File > Add Folder to Picasa. Once a folder of images is added to Picasa, a thumbnail of all the images shows up in the gallery. Double-click on any image to start touching up the image.

The most basic operations required to touch up an image are neatly displayed in the Basic Fixes tab. Select the operation you want to perform to bring up the operation-specific menu. If the subject is off centre, or only a part of the image needs to be focused on, you can crop the image. Picasa automatically detects interesting elements in an image, and focuses on that part of the image when you use the cropping tool.

There are a number of preset sizes, which are dimensions of common prints. You can also choose to use a custom size. One part of the image will be highlighted, which will be the image after cropping. Once a suitable selection is made, click on Apply. Note that all changes done in Picasa does not affect the original photo, only a version Picasa automatically highlights objects of the photo in Picasa.

